



What actually went right last week

The 5 stories readers chose, week of 21 September

Zoom out: Tuberculosis has killed more people than any other infectious disease in history. Treatment has saved an estimated 83 million lives since 2000. (World Health Organization)

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Kenya's Sheldrick Wildlife Trust keeper Misheck spent five months without a day off caring for Wangalla, a week-old elephant calf found hiding among zebras after lions scattered her herd.

What it proves: Misheck's five months of near-constant care show a week-old orphaned elephant can be brought back to a stable, social life in a sanctuary.



Kazakhstan's Kok-Aral Dam increased the northern Aral Sea's water volume 68%, halved its salinity and more than tripled fish production, while Uzbekistan planted 4.2 million acres of the exposed lakebed.

What it proves: A single dam project can partly reverse the shrinking of a major inland sea within a few years.

32%

Burkina Faso's malaria vaccine rollout helped cut recorded cases by 32% and malaria deaths by 44% between 2024 and 2025.

What it proves: Burkina Faso's combined vaccination and prevention program shows a country can nearly halve malaria deaths within two years.

Researchers at NHS Blood and Transplant traced the rare AnWj blood antigen to the MAL gene, solving a mystery open since 1972 and creating a new blood group system.

What it proves: This discovery lets blood banks genetically screen for the extremely rare AnWj negative donors who were previously nearly impossible to identify.

\$250 million

Dave and Cheryl Duffield's foundation committed \$250 million over five years to expand nonprofit veterinary care for pet owners who cannot afford it.

What it proves: Dave and Cheryl Duffield's gift shows a single foundation can fund a five year national fix for the 50 million pet care gap the Foundation identified.

All five stories are linked in the post text above.

“What you do makes a difference, and you have to decide what kind of difference you want to make.”

Jane Goodall

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